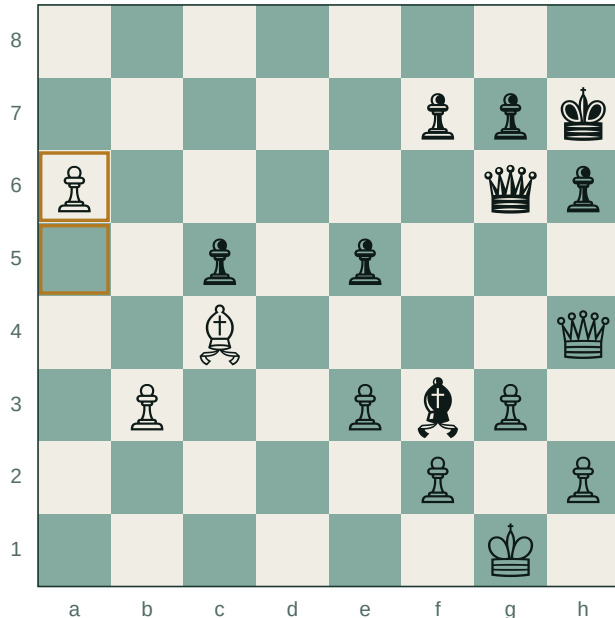


Pins and pressure: Black, move 37

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 37.a6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Qb1+ 38. Bf1 Be2 39. Qh3 Bxa6

37...Qb1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **38.Bf1**.

38...Be2 The bishop moves from f3 to e2. Recorded reply: **39.Qh3**.

39...Bxa6 The bishop captures the pawn on a6.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on g3.